

The Information Daily Briefing

3 September 2026 (GMT+8)

Coverage window: 2–3 September 2026

The Information Daily Briefing — 3 September 2026

Sources: *The Information* (AM Briefing, The Briefing, AI Agenda, The Information Finance, The Electric newsletters) and *theinformation.com*, covering the 24 hours to 06:00 HKT, 3 September 2026.

1. Google wins the ad tech remedies ruling — no divestiture, behavioural fixes only

- **What:** Judge **Leonie Brinkema** issued a brief ruling on Wednesday **rejecting the Justice Department's demand for structural remedies** — a forced divestiture of Google's ad tech stack — and accepting most of the proposed **behavioural remedies** instead. Google was found a monopolist in ad tech (the second DOJ case it lost on liability), but keeps the assets. The full text of the ruling is not expected for a couple of weeks.
 - **Why:** Google's defence was that the open-web display market is in structural decline, and the judge appears to have accepted it. The numbers support the argument: **network ad revenue was just 9% of Google's ad revenue in Q2 2026, down from 17% in 2018**, with dollars migrating to video streaming and mobile apps where Google does not dominate — and with Google's own AI Overviews cutting referral traffic to independent publishers.
 - **When:** Ruling issued Wednesday 2 September 2026; full opinion due in ~2 weeks.
 - **Which:** Alphabet (GOOGL); read-across to The Trade Desk (TTD), PubMatic (PUBM), Magnite (MGNI), Criteo (CRTO) and other independent ad tech; also Amazon (AMZN), now facing an FTC ad-auction suit filed 31 August.
 - **How:** This is the **second consecutive antitrust case where Google lost on liability but effectively won on remedy** (the search case ended the same way, with the judge weighing AI's disruptive effect). The practical lesson for investors: tech antitrust in the US now moves too slowly relative to technology cycles to produce structural outcomes. Regulatory-overhang discounts on large-cap platforms look increasingly mispriced.
 - **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/newsletters/the-briefing>
-

2. Broadcom guides AI revenue to \$115bn in 2027 and potentially \$230bn in 2028

- **What:** CEO **Hock Tan** projected Broadcom would **double AI revenue to \$115 billion in 2027**, and potentially **double again to ~\$230 billion in 2028**. The guidance accompanied results for the quarter ending 2 August: **revenue up 86% to \$29.6 billion**.
 - **Why:** Broadcom is the primary partner for custom AI accelerators (XPU's) at **Google, Meta and OpenAI**. The guide is a statement that hyperscaler and lab custom-silicon programmes are not merely continuing but re-accelerating — a direct challenge to the assumption that Nvidia captures the entire AI compute wallet.
 - **When:** Reported Wednesday 2 September 2026 (quarter ended 2 August).
 - **Which:** Broadcom (AVGO); read-across to Nvidia (NVDA), Marvell (MRVL), Alchip, TSMC (TSM), Alphabet (GOOGL), Meta (META), Astera Labs (ALAB), Credo (CRDO).
 - **How:** A ~\$230bn 2028 AI revenue line for a single merchant silicon vendor is a very large number — roughly the scale of Nvidia's entire data centre business at the start of this cycle. It is credible only if the announced data centre buildout is fully financed and delivered. **Treat the 2028 figure as an option, not a base case:** it is contingent on customers (several of them cash-burning labs) honouring multi-year commitments.
 - **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/newsletters/the-briefing>
-

3. Microsoft will finally disclose Azure revenue — but bundles away the margin

- **What:** Microsoft is **overhauling segment reporting and will disclose Azure revenue quarterly**. The June quarter comparison is now visible for the first time: **AWS \$42.0bn, Azure \$29.4bn, Google Cloud \$24.7bn**. However, Microsoft is **collapsing three segments into two**, merging Azure with the Microsoft 365 cloud software business.
 - **Why:** Nadella framed it as “increased transparency to investors.” In practice we gain a revenue line and **lose the operating margin split** — previously the Azure-containing segment ran a **41% operating margin** versus **58%** for the Microsoft 365 segment. Going forward, one blended cloud-plus-software profit number will obscure whether AI infrastructure margins are compressing.
 - **When:** Announced Wednesday 2 September 2026.
 - **Which:** Microsoft (MSFT); comparables Amazon (AMZN), Alphabet (GOOGL), Oracle (ORCL), CoreWeave (CRWV), Nebius (NBIS).
 - **How:** Microsoft's stated rationale — that Azure and M365 share AI chips and capacity, so segmenting them is artificial — is defensible. But the timing is notable. **Disclosure that adds a topline and removes a margin arrives precisely when the market's central question is AI infrastructure profitability.** Model AI capex-to-margin transmission from the merchant vendors (AVGO, NVDA, DELL) rather than from MSFT's own disclosures.
 - **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/newsletters/the-briefing>
-

4. DOJ backs OpenAI against The New York Times on AI training and copyright

- **What:** The **Justice Department** filed a **brief** in the NYT v. OpenAI copyright case arguing that **training AI models on copyrighted material does not violate copyright law**. The government framed the stakes in national security terms: “Rules of law that make it significantly more difficult to develop a robust AI industry in the United States therefore threaten national security and give a competitive advantage to foreign adversaries who are not so encumbered.”
 - **Why:** This is the executive branch intervening on the side of a private AI developer against a news publisher — a substantive shift in the government’s posture on the single largest legal risk overhanging frontier labs. It arrives alongside the “Carolina Principles” agenda from this week’s G20 innovation event, and after David Sacks publicly derided the idea of an “FDA for AI.”
 - **When:** Filed Wednesday 2 September 2026.
 - **Which:** OpenAI (private), New York Times Co. (NYT), News Corp (NWSA), Getty Images (GETY), Alphabet (GOOGL), Meta (META), Anthropic (private); licensing-model beneficiaries Shutterstock (SSTK), Reddit (RDDT).
 - **How:** The direction of policy travel is **de-regulatory and pro-developer**: a stalled AI self-regulation executive order, a rejected federal AI approval regulator, DOJ backing fair-use training, and remedies-light antitrust. This compresses the legal-risk discount on model developers and **weakens the negotiating position of content owners** who have been pricing licensing deals off litigation risk.
 - **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/newsletters/the-briefing>
-

5. OpenAI’s ‘Astra’: a capability jump that may break chain-of-thought oversight

- **What:** The Information’s AI Agenda detailed the technique behind OpenAI’s forthcoming **Astra** model — related to **loop transformers and recurrent depth**, in which the model repeatedly cycles a question through its own layers before emitting the next token. Some researchers believe the resulting capability jump could rival **GPT-4’s 2023 leap**, well beyond GPT-5. Separately, OpenAI said Astra is the **first model it has designated at the “Critical” cybersecurity threshold** under its Preparedness Framework — able to find and exploit unknown security flaws across well-protected systems without step-by-step human guidance — and will restrict access to a small tester group, later widening via its Daybreak Blue programme.
- **Why:** The safety cost is structural. Today’s oversight relies on reading models’ written **chains of thought**. Looping computation lets models “think silently,” so less of the reasoning is externalised and monitorable — the very mechanism OpenAI proposed after the July Hugging Face incident. The Information reports these techniques are **already under discussion at every major lab**, so Anthropic and Google are likely to follow.
- **When:** Reported Tuesday 1 – Wednesday 2 September 2026; Astra unreleased.
- **Which:** OpenAI (private), Microsoft (MSFT), Nvidia (NVDA), Anthropic (private), Alphabet (GOOGL); security beneficiaries Palo Alto Networks (PANW), CrowdStrike (CRWD), Zscaler (ZS), SentinelOne (S), CyberArk.

- **How:** For now OpenAI is deliberately **limiting loop counts to keep the chain of thought visible** — an explicit capability-for-oversight trade. That trade is only stable while no competitor defects. Note the commercial read-through: recurrent depth lets a smaller model perform like a much larger one, which **shifts value from raw parameter scale toward inference-time compute** — good for inference silicon and neoclouds, less good for a pure “bigger training run wins” thesis.
 - **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/articles/openai-technique-astra-model-sparks-security-concerns>
-

6. Power, not chips, is the binding constraint: Musk warns of a 15GW shortfall

- **What:** At the **G20 innovation event in North Carolina**, Elon Musk (virtually) lamented a global “**crisis of power**,” citing a likely **15 gigawatt shortage next year** for AI chips and calling on other countries to build data centres to serve compute-starved AI companies. He also predicted AI would grow global GDP **20–30% annually** and forecast **a billion humanoid robots within a decade**, five times more productive than humans. **Anthropic co-founder Tom Brown** made the same “build more data centres” call at the same event. Jensen Huang and Sam Altman were scheduled for day two.
 - **Why:** Every AI capex thesis now routes through electricity. **SoftBank’s SB Energy filed to go public** the same week with explicit neocloud ambitions — while disclosing it has “**no data center capacity**” **currently operating**, revenue of just **\$213.5m last year** and over **\$1bn of cash burn**, mostly capex. Nvidia is investing **\$3bn** (half via a prepaid forward with parent Energy Global, half at IPO). Separately, **SpaceX is laying groundwork for a turbine-blade factory** and **Cerebras with Compute Nordic** announced a Finland site scaling to **165MW**.
 - **When:** G20 event Tuesday 1 – Wednesday 2 September 2026; SB Energy S-1 filed this week.
 - **Which:** Tesla (TSLA), SpaceX (private), SoftBank (9984.T), SB Energy (IPO pending), Nvidia (NVDA), Cerebras (private), Vertiv (VRT), GE Vernova (GEV), Constellation Energy (CEG), Vistra (VST), Talen (TLN), Bloom Energy (BE), Quanta Services (PWR), Eaton (ETN).
 - **How:** Musk’s macro forecasts are promotional and his Tesla comp package is tied to Optimus — discount accordingly. **The power shortage claim is the credible part.** The investable expression is the pick-and-shovel layer: turbines, transformers, switchgear, cooling and behind-the-meter generation, where order books are contracted and less exposed to whether any individual lab honours its lease. SB Energy is the clearest case of **narrative-priced supply reaching public markets ahead of operating assets** — a marker for how late this financing cycle is.
 - **Links:** <https://www.theinformation.com/briefings/elon-musk-calls-countries-build-data-centers-north-carolina-g20-meeting> · <https://www.theinformation.com/briefings/softbanks-sb-energy-files-go-public>
-

7. KKR's \$10bn Helix hires from Equinix and AES — private credit institutionalises AI infrastructure

- **What:** KKR's **\$10 billion AI venture, Helix Digital Infrastructure**, made its first two senior hires under CEO **Adam Selipsky** (ex-AWS chief): **Jonathan Lin**, former chief business officer of **Equinix**, to run data centre strategy and execution, and **Kleber Costa**, previously chief commercial officer of the clean energy business at **AES**, to lead power and energy operations. **Nvidia is among Helix's backers.**
 - **Why:** The hires are diagnostic of where the bottleneck sits. KKR did not hire two data centre people — it hired **one data centre executive and one power executive**. That is the same message as story 6, expressed through a capital allocator's org chart.
 - **When:** Reported Wednesday 2 September 2026.
 - **Which:** KKR (KKR), Nvidia (NVDA), Equinix (EQIX), AES (AES), Digital Realty (DLR), Blackstone (BX), Brookfield (BAM), Blue Owl (OWL).
 - **How:** Alternative asset managers are now **originating AI infrastructure directly** rather than lending against it — with Nvidia again appearing on the equity side of a vehicle that will buy its chips. That circularity (vendor equity → neocloud/infra vehicle → chip purchases) recurs across Lambda, Nscale, SB Energy and now Helix. It is the single most important structural feature of this cycle to monitor, because it makes demand signals partially self-referential.
 - **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/articles/two-new-executives-steering-kkrs-10-billion-ai-infrastructure-bet>
-

8. Earnings: Dell, Snowflake, Palo Alto and Nscale all confirm AI demand is still translating into revenue

- **What:** **Dell** revenue rose **58% to \$47bn** for the quarter ending July, and raised FY guidance by **\$25bn to \$192bn** (+70% y/y), with **\$74bn of AI server revenue expected this year, up 200%**; net income up 255% to \$4.1bn; stock +8% after hours, **+237% YTD**. **Snowflake** shares rose **>20%** after beating its product revenue forecast by more than **\$70m** for the quarter ending 31 July. **Palo Alto Networks** grew revenue **34% to \$3.4bn** (accelerating from 31%), with **XSIAM ARR above \$700m** (from \$400m) and its AI-agent security product above **\$120m ARR** — but posted a **\$282m net loss** on CyberArk deal costs. **Nscale** told prospective investors it has **~\$103bn of total contracted revenue** after a **\$45bn Anthropic deal**, with an IPO possibly this month.
- **Why:** The demand side of the AI trade is not softening. Notably, **the growth is spreading beyond the obvious names** — from Nvidia into servers (Dell), data platforms (Snowflake) and security (Palo Alto, explicitly monetising AI-agent risk).
- **When:** All reported 1–2 September 2026.
- **Which:** Dell (DELL), Snowflake (SNOW), Palo Alto Networks (PANW), CyberArk (acquired), Nvidia (NVDA), Nscale (IPO pending), CoreWeave (CRWV), Super Micro (SMCI), HPE (HPE).
- **How:** Two cautions. First, **Dell's AI server business carries structurally thin margins** — revenue growth of this magnitude does not translate proportionally to

profit. Second, **Nscale's "\$103bn contracted revenue" is a backlog figure disclosed to pre-IPO investors**, concentrated in Anthropic and Microsoft — counterparty concentration is the entire risk. Palo Alto is the cleanest expression here: real ARR acceleration in a category (agent security) created by the risks described in story 5.

- **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/newsletters/the-briefing>
-

9. Uber cuts 10% of staff and ends remote work — the first large non-AI-native cost reset

- **What:** Uber is laying off 10% of its workforce (~3,400 people), framed as removing management layers. CEO **Dara Khosrowshahi** told staff “the vast majority” of remote employees must return to an office, **cutting fully remote staff to ~1%**.
 - **Why:** Uber is not an AI lab and is not cutting to fund a training run. This is a mature platform company **stripping middle management** at the exact moment AI tooling is credibly compressing coordination work. Expect this framing to be copied.
 - **When:** Announced Wednesday 2 September 2026.
 - **Which:** Uber (UBER); read-across to Lyft (LYFT), DoorDash (DASH), Salesforce (CRM), Workday (WDAY) and other large-cap software/platform employers.
 - **How:** Margin expansion from headcount reduction is real and near-term, and the market has rewarded it consistently this cycle. The question to ask is **whether the cuts are efficiency or demand**: Uber's framing is efficiency, and the simultaneous RTO mandate suggests a culture reset rather than distress. But layered management cuts also reduce a company's ability to absorb a downturn.
 - **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/newsletters/the-briefing>
-

10. CFTC targets prediction markets' affiliated trading arms — and New Jersey goes to the Supreme Court

- **What:** The **CFTC is seeking comment on proposed rules** barring exchanges from advantaging affiliated trading firms — requiring separate offices, personnel and systems, prohibiting **directional (speculative) bets against customers**, and requiring independent traders' orders be filled ahead of affiliates' at the same price. The agency says it knows of **at least six exchanges** permitting affiliated trading. Separately, **New Jersey regulators petitioned the US Supreme Court** to rule whether sports contracts from **Kalshi** and **Polymarket** fall outside state gambling regulation.
- **Why:** The regulatory template is post-FTX/**Alameda**: preventing an exchange and a proprietary trading desk from sitting inside one corporate group. **Kalshi** — the largest US prediction market, **close to raising at a \$40bn valuation** — owns **Kalshi Trading**, which trades on its own exchange; it says the unit is unprofitable, shares no personnel or premises, and that all institutional market makers are **<5% of volume on its most liquid contracts**. **Polymarket** says it operates no market maker. **Robinhood** holds 45% of **Rothera**, a joint venture exchange with **Susquehanna**, which makes markets on it.

- **When:** CFTC comment period ends **early October 2026**; NJ Supreme Court petition filed this week.
 - **Which:** Robinhood (HOOD), Susquehanna (private), Kalshi (private, ~\$40bn), Polymarket (private), DraftKings (DKNG), Flutter/FanDuel (FLUT), CME (CME), Intercontinental Exchange (ICE).
 - **How:** There is a real legal tension here worth pricing. Prediction markets argue for **federal rather than state** jurisdiction partly on the grounds that, unlike sportsbooks, **they do not trade against customers** — a claim that an affiliated market-making arm arguably undermines, since a market maker takes the other side of every trade. **A Supreme Court grant would be the single largest binary event for DKNG and FLUT**, cutting either way: it could legitimise a federally regulated competitor to state-licensed sportsbooks, or force prediction markets into state licensing. Structural separation rules would also raise Kalshi's cost of liquidity provision — relevant to a \$40bn private mark.
 - **Links:** <https://www.theinformation.com/newsletters/the-information-finance> · <https://www.theinformation.com/briefings/new-jersey-asks-supreme-court-rule-prediction-markets>
-

11. A Pentagon-backed drone battery standard aims to break China's 90% chokehold

- **What:** SAE International released the **first formal industry standard for drone batteries** — a flat **pouch cell** replacing the Chinese cylindrical **2170** cell, sized to substitute for a typical six-cell 2170 pack. The **Department of Defense backed the effort** and appears likely to adopt it for the **Drone Dominance Program**, under which the Pentagon may eventually buy **millions of drones per year**. The origin: after the US approved attack drone sales to Taiwan in 2024, **Beijing blocked battery sales to Skydio**, the largest US drone maker, creating an acute supply crunch.
- **Why:** **~90% of power cells are made in China**. Standardisation is the specific lever that lowers the barrier to a non-Chinese supply base: changing a cell's dimensions can force **\$30m of equipment replacement**, so fixing dimensions removes the largest source of capex uncertainty for a new entrant. **EnPower** (Indiana) is retooling for **2m+ cells annually** from mid-2027 despite having **no firm contracts**; **Amprius** will ship a standard-format cell in Q4 at **500 Wh/kg** — nearly double conventional lithium-ion; South Korea's **BEI** already makes a conforming cell.
- **When:** Standard released July 2026; reported Wednesday 2 September 2026.
- **Which:** Amprius Technologies (AMPX), EnPower (private), BEI (private), Skydio (private), AeroVironment (AVAV), Kratos (KTOS), Anduril (private), Ouster/defence optics; also **GoPro (GPRO)**, which this week agreed to sell **90% to Starman Optical for \$285m (\$1.14/share, +40%)** to pivot into defence, data centre, aerospace and robotics optics after warning in June of going-concern doubt.
- **How:** The addressable market extends well beyond drones — EnPower's CEO is explicitly evangelising the format for **industrial and humanoid robots**. The risk is that standard-setting creates capacity ahead of contracts: EnPower is building without

orders, which is a policy bet, not a demand signal. Watch for the DoD to formally adopt the standard in the Drone Dominance Program — **that procurement decision is what converts this from a standards story into a revenue story.**

- **Link:** <https://www.theinformation.com/newsletters/the-electric>
-

12. Model releases and the enterprise cost war: Anthropic cuts price 25%, Meta ships, Glean attacks token economics

- **What:** Anthropic released **Claude Fable 5.1** at an estimated **25% lower token cost** than Fable 5 on typical workloads (larger savings claimed on agentic work), plus **Claude Mythos 5.1** for cybersecurity and life sciences partners, and a forthcoming **Enterprise Frontier Safeguards** data system offering zero-data-retention-equivalent privacy from later this autumn. **Meta** shipped **Muse Voice Transcribe** (70+ languages, speaker segmentation, 20+ speaker sessions) and **Muse Spark 1.3**, and took **Muse Code** out of beta at up to **\$50/month**. **World Labs** unveiled **Atlas**, a world model generating navigable photorealistic 3D environments. **Glean** claims Anthropic customers' bills are **80% higher than necessary**.
 - **Why:** Frontier model pricing is falling while capability rises — the classic signature of a **commoditising input**. Anthropic cutting price 25% within a point release, while simultaneously committing to **\$120bn+ of compute leases**, is the central tension in the AI trade: **input costs are contracted and fixed; output prices are competitive and falling**.
 - **When:** All announced 1–2 September 2026.
 - **Which:** Anthropic (private), Meta (META), Alphabet (GOOGL), Microsoft (MSFT), Nvidia (NVDA), World Labs (private), Glean (private), ByteDance (private); infrastructure Nscale, Lambda, CoreWeave (CRWV).
 - **How:** Two structural notes. First, **Meta reversing its own decision to move internal chat from Google Chat to Slack** — chief AI officer Alexandr Wang conceding “we made the wrong decision” because **Slack is the strongest platform for agents** — is a live, unsolicited datapoint for Salesforce's agent thesis. Second, **World Labs' Atlas now competes with Google's Gemini Omni and faces a wave of Chinese world-model startups**, and world models are the enabling layer for humanoid robotics and autonomous driving — a category to track separately from LLMs.
 - **Links:** <https://www.theinformation.com/briefings/anthropic-touts-better-performance-lower-cost-upgraded-top-models> · <https://www.theinformation.com/briefings/fei-fei-lis-world-labs-unveils-new-world-model> · <https://www.theinformation.com/briefings/meta-moves-internal-chat-google-slack>
-

Overall Market Summary

Market trend

The last 24 hours delivered an unusually clean, one-directional message: **the AI capital cycle is intact, accelerating, and being actively de-risked by the US government.**

Broadcom guided to a doubling and possible re-doubling of AI revenue through 2028. Dell raised full-year guidance by \$25bn. Snowflake beat and rose 20%. Palo Alto accelerated to 34% growth explicitly on AI-driven security demand. Nscale is marketing a \$103bn backlog into an imminent IPO. Nothing in the tape suggests demand deceleration.

What changed today is the **policy backdrop**. Google escaped divestiture in its second lost antitrust case. The DOJ intervened *on OpenAI's side* against The New York Times on the core question of training data. The White House used a G20 event to promote “limited regulation” under the Carolina Principles, while a former AI czar publicly ridiculed the notion of a pre-release approval regulator. Taken together, the three principal legal-regulatory risks to large-cap tech and frontier labs — structural antitrust, copyright liability, and licensing-style AI regulation — all moved materially in the industry’s favour on a single day.

Beneath that, the **bottleneck has migrated decisively from silicon to electricity**. Musk’s 15GW shortfall warning, Anthropic’s co-founder calling for state-built data centres, KKR hiring a power executive alongside a data centre executive, SpaceX planning turbine-blade manufacturing, Cerebras contracting 165MW in Finland, and SB Energy filing to go public on a neocloud narrative — these are one story, not six.

Sentiment

Risk-on, verging on complacent. The combination of accelerating reported revenue and a visibly friendlier state is exactly the setup in which valuation discipline erodes. Two markers stand out. SB Energy is attempting a public listing with **zero operating data centre capacity, \$213.5m of revenue and >\$1bn of cash burn** — narrative reaching public markets ahead of assets. And Kalshi is raising at **\$40bn** while facing simultaneous CFTC market-structure rulemaking and a Supreme Court petition on its core sports product.

Against that, the **cost side is deflating**: Anthropic cut token pricing 25% in a point release, and Glean is publicly attacking frontier-lab token economics with an 80%-overbilling claim. The bull case requires volume growth to outrun price decline indefinitely.

Important questions being asked — and how they were answered today

1. Can antitrust still structurally alter big tech? *Answered: no, at least not in the US on current timelines.* Two DOJ wins on liability, two remedies that leave Google’s businesses intact. Courts are explicitly weighing AI-driven market change. The overhang discount on GOOGL — and by extension AMZN in its FTC ad case — should narrow.

2. Is training on copyrighted data legally safe? *Answered: the US executive branch now says yes.* The DOJ's national security framing is a significant tailwind for OpenAI, Anthropic, Meta and Google, and a corresponding headwind for publishers' licensing leverage. Not dispositive — the court still rules — but the direction is clear.

3. What is actually constraining AI buildout? *Answered: power, not chips.* Explicitly quantified at ~15GW next year. Every capital allocator in today's reporting is behaving as though this is true.

4. Are AI infrastructure margins holding? *Deliberately obscured.* Microsoft will give us Azure revenue but is removing the segment margin that would have answered the question. This is the most important unanswered question in the complex, and disclosure just got worse.

5. Can we still supervise frontier models? *Answered: less well than yesterday.* Recurrent-depth reasoning lets models think without externalising thought, degrading chain-of-thought monitoring. OpenAI is voluntarily throttling loop depth to preserve visibility, and has designated Astra the first model at its "Critical" cybersecurity threshold. The safeguard holds only while no lab defects.

6. Is the demand real or circular? *Unresolved, and worsening.* Nvidia appears on the equity side of Lambda, SB Energy and now KKR's Helix — all of which buy Nvidia chips. Anthropic has committed \$120bn+ across Nscale, Lambda and SpaceX while cutting its own prices 25%.

Key risks

Risk	Description	Watch for
Vendor-financed circularity	Nvidia equity flowing into entities whose principal purpose is buying Nvidia silicon (Lambda, SB Energy, Helix). Demand signals become partially self-referential.	Related-party disclosure in the SB Energy and Nscale S-1s
Counterparty concentration	Nscale's \$103bn "contracted revenue" and Anthropic's \$120bn+ of leases rest on a handful of cash-burning private labs.	Anthropic's IPO terms; any renegotiated lease
Margin opacity	Microsoft's segment merger removes the cleanest read on AI infrastructure profitability just as it matters most.	AVGO, DELL, NVDA gross margins as proxies
Price deflation vs fixed cost	Anthropic -25% pricing and Glean's overbilling	Token pricing at OpenAI/Google's next

	attack against multi-year fixed compute leases.	release
Agent security	Astra at “Critical” cyber threshold; degraded chain-of-thought oversight; PANW’s Arora citing OpenAI’s breaches as the sales case.	A first material agent-driven breach at a regulated institution
Narrative-priced supply	SB Energy IPO with no operating capacity; Nscale IPO on backlog; Kalshi at \$40bn into active rulemaking.	Pricing and aftermarket performance of the SB Energy and Nscale IPOs
Power/permitting	A 15GW shortfall is not solvable on AI’s timeline; grid interconnection queues and turbine lead times bind.	Utility interconnection announcements; GEV/VRT backlog
Regulatory reversal	Today’s de-regulatory posture is executive-branch policy, reversible with an administration or a salient incident.	Supreme Court action on prediction markets; NYT case ruling
Litigation tail	30 new complaints against OpenAI now allege <i>aiding and abetting</i> the Tumbler Ridge shooting, not merely negligence.	Motion-to-dismiss rulings
Labour signal	Uber cutting 10% and ending remote work may mark the start of AI-justified white-collar reductions at non-AI firms.	Follow-on announcements at large-cap platforms

Investment Implications

Companies below are drawn directly from the articles above. This is analysis of what was reported, not investment advice — no recommendation is made and readers should form their own view.

Positive read-through

- **Broadcom (AVGO)** — The most consequential guide of the day: AI revenue to \$115bn in 2027, potentially \$230bn in 2028, on 86% growth to \$29.6bn. Custom XPU

programmes at Google, Meta and OpenAI are re-accelerating. The clearest evidence that AI compute spend is not consolidating solely into Nvidia. *Caveat: the 2028 number is a contingent option on a fully financed buildout.*

- **Dell (DELL)** — 58% revenue growth to \$47bn, FY guide raised \$25bn to \$192bn, AI server revenue guided to \$74bn (+200%), net income +255%, +237% YTD. The purest volume read on AI server demand. *Caveat: structurally thin AI server margins mean revenue growth does not flow proportionally to profit.*
- **Palo Alto Networks (PANW)** — Growth accelerating (31% → 34%), XSIAM ARR \$400m → \$700m+, agent-security product past \$120m ARR, closed Console. Directly monetises the risk described in story 5. *Caveat: \$282m net loss on CyberArk costs; multiple already reflects the AI-security narrative.*
- **Snowflake (SNOW)** — Beat product revenue by \$70m+, shares +20%. Data platforms are participating in AI monetisation, not being disintermediated by it.
- **Alphabet (GOOGL)** — Escaped divestiture in a second lost antitrust case. Regulatory overhang narrows materially. Also a Broadcom XPU customer and a World Labs competitor via Gemini Omni. *Caveat: the ad tech asset the company retained is a declining 9%-of-ads business.*
- **Power & electrical infrastructure — GE Vernova (GEV), Vertiv (VRT), Eaton (ETN), Quanta (PWR), Constellation (CEG), Vistra (VST), Bloom Energy (BE)** — The 15GW shortfall, KKR's power hire, SpaceX's turbine-blade plans and Cerebras' 165MW Finland site all point one way. Contracted, backlog-driven exposure that is less sensitive to whether any individual lab honours its leases.
- **KKR (KKR)** — Deploying \$10bn into AI infrastructure with credible operating leadership (ex-AWS CEO, ex-Equinix, ex-AES) and Nvidia alongside. Alt managers originating rather than lending. *Caveat: entering at a late-cycle price point.*
- **Amprius (AMPX)** — Shipping a standard-format 500 Wh/kg cell in Q4 into a DoD-backed standard. Small-cap, high-beta, and the demand is policy-contingent.
- **Salesforce (CRM)** — Meta publicly reversing its Google Chat decision because “Slack is the strongest platform for agents,” in Alexandr Wang's words, is an unusually strong third-party validation of the agent thesis.

Negative or pressured read-through

- **New York Times Co. (NYT)** and content owners broadly (**NWSA, GETY**) — The DOJ arguing that AI training does not infringe copyright weakens the litigation leverage underpinning AI licensing economics.
- **Independent ad tech — The Trade Desk (TTD), PubMatic (PUBM), Magnite (MGNI), Criteo (CRTO)** — Two damaging facts in one ruling: no forced Google divestiture (no share opportunity), and a judicial finding that the open-web display market is structurally declining, with Google's network ads down from 17% to 9% of its ad revenue since 2018.
- **Microsoft (MSFT)** — Not a demand problem; a disclosure problem. Gaining an Azure revenue line while losing the segment margin split reduces analyst ability to verify AI profitability at precisely the wrong moment. Expect a modest transparency discount.

- **DraftKings (DKNG), Flutter/FanDuel (FLUT)** — New Jersey’s Supreme Court petition makes the prediction-market threat a genuine binary. A ruling favouring Kalshi/Polymarket would legitimise federally regulated competitors carrying lower state tax and licensing burdens.
- **Robinhood (HOOD)** — Its 45% Rothera stake alongside Susquehanna’s market making is squarely within the CFTC’s affiliated-trading proposal. Structural separation would raise costs in a fast-growing revenue line.
- **Uber (UBER)** — Near-term margin positive, but a 10% cut plus a full RTO mandate reduces organisational slack. Watch whether peers follow, which would signal an efficiency wave rather than a company-specific reset.

Private / pre-IPO to monitor

- **SB Energy** — Nvidia investing \$3bn (half prepaid forward via Energy Global, half at IPO) into a company with no operating data centre capacity, \$213.5m revenue and >\$1bn burn. The most instructive pricing test of the quarter.
 - **Nscale** — ~\$103bn contracted revenue, \$45bn Anthropic deal, ~\$3bn of new loan facilities for Texas and North Carolina sites, IPO possibly this month. Backlog quality and counterparty concentration are the whole question.
 - **Anthropic** — Considering allowing shareholders to sell in its IPO, departing from the SpaceX playbook. Cutting prices 25% while carrying \$120bn+ of compute commitments.
 - **Kalshi** — Close to raising at \$40bn while facing CFTC rulemaking on its affiliated trading arm and a Supreme Court petition on its core sports contracts.
 - **OpenAI** — Astra could be a GPT-4-scale capability jump; also the first model at OpenAI’s “Critical” cyber threshold, with DOJ support in the NYT case and 30 new aiding-and-abetting complaints.
 - **Glean** — Attacking frontier-lab token economics (80% overbilling claim) from a \$7.2bn valuation. The middleware-routing layer is becoming a structural cap on model pricing power.
-

Prepared 3 September 2026, 06:00 HKT. Sources: The Information newsletters (The Briefing, The Information AM, AI Agenda, The Information Finance, The Electric) and theinformation.com, 2–3 September 2026. Not investment advice.